

BASKETBALL BETTING GAME — MVP GAME VISION & TECHNICAL SPECIFICATION

Core Vision

We want to build a basketball betting game that feels fundamentally different from a traditional casino game.

The main vision is:

The user should feel like they are playing a basketball shooting game, not simply pressing a button and waiting for a random gambling result.

Traditional casino games such as roulette provide very little interaction after the bet is placed. The player chooses the bet, waits for the roulette wheel to stop, and receives the result.

Our basketball game should create a much deeper and more entertaining experience.

The player should feel involved in every shot.

The entertainment should come from:

- Choosing a basketball character
- Choosing between different shooting challenges
- Timing the shot
- Watching the shooting animation
- Watching the defender attempt a block in Three-Point Mode
- Following the ball toward the basket
- Seeing different rim and backboard interactions
- Experiencing close makes and misses
- Slow-motion moments
- Character and crowd reactions

The most important principle is:

This should feel like a basketball game with a betting system behind it — not a casino game with a basketball animation on top.

MVP – Technical Game Specification

Before starting each round, the player must select three parameters:

1. Bet Size

2. Player / Character

3. Game Mode

For the initial MVP, there will be two game modes:

Free Throw

and

Three-Point Shot

Camera & Player Experience

The game should be played primarily from a **third-person perspective**.

The basketball player and their shooting motion should be clearly visible.

The appearance and personality of each character should have an important role in the user experience.

Players may develop preferences toward specific characters and may personally feel that they perform better or are "luckier" with certain players.

For example:

- Tall / short
- Heavy / slim
- Muscular / athletic
- Different skin tones
- Tattoos
- Long hair / short hair / shaved head
- Different basketball clothing
- Different shoes
- Different shooting styles

For the initial MVP, approximately **3–5 clearly differentiated basketball players** should be available.

It is important that they feel like genuinely different characters rather than the same player model with different clothing.

Optional Player Attributes

Each character could have visible basketball-style attributes such as:

- Shooting
- Accuracy
- Release Speed
- Power
- Three-Point Rating

These attributes can primarily exist to add personality, depth and perceived strategy to character selection.

If the attributes do not actually modify the underlying probability of winning, the game should not communicate to the player that selecting a higher-rated character increases their real winning probability.

Game Modes

1. Free Throw

Free Throw should be the simpler of the two initial modes.

The player stands at the free-throw line and takes a normal basketball free throw.

IMPORTANT:

There is NO defender in Free Throw Mode.

Nobody attempts to block the shot.

The experience focuses entirely on:

- The player
- Shooting motion
- Timing
- Ball trajectory
- Rim interaction

- Basket
- Crowd
- Result

This should be the cleaner and faster game mode.

2. Three-Point Shot

Three-Point Mode should be more difficult, dynamic and visually exciting.

Unlike the Free Throw mode:

THERE IS AN ACTIVE DEFENDER.

The defender should attempt to close down the shooter and block the shot.

This is an important part of the Three-Point experience.

The player should not always successfully release the basketball.

Sometimes:

Shooter prepares → Defender jumps → Shooter releases → Ball travels toward basket

But other times:

Shooter prepares → Defender jumps → BLOCK

The defender successfully prevents or blocks the shot.

This gives us another way of presenting unsuccessful outcomes rather than having every loss simply be a missed basket.

Three-Point Defender System

The defender should make the Three-Point Mode feel significantly different from Free Throw Mode.

We should create multiple defensive scenarios.

Scenario A — Clean Shot

The shooter creates enough space and gets a clean shot.

Scenario B — Contested Shot

The defender gets very close and jumps, but the shooter manages to release the ball.

Scenario C — Block

The defender successfully blocks the shot.

Scenario D — Slight Deflection

The shooter releases the ball, but the defender gets a hand on it and changes the trajectory.

Scenario E — Very Close Contest

The defender almost blocks the ball, creating a dramatic animation, but the shot is successfully released.

The defender should therefore become a major part of the suspense of Three-Point Mode.

Shooting Mechanics

The shooting interaction is one of the most important elements of the game.

We want a basketball-style **Shot Timing Meter**.

The user presses/taps to release the basketball at what they believe is the correct moment.

The meter could contain zones such as:

EARLY → GOOD → PERFECT → GOOD → LATE

The center / Perfect zone could visually appear green.

This creates interaction between placing the bet and seeing the final result.

However, if the timing meter does not actually change the mathematical probability of the gambling outcome, it should not be presented to the player as though it does.

The timing meter can still influence the visual presentation and feeling of the shot without falsely communicating a change in winning probability.

Shot Animations & Excitement

Animation quality is one of the highest priorities of the entire product.

We should NOT create a system where:

WIN = same basket animation

and

LOSS = same missed shot animation.

Both winning and losing outcomes should have multiple possible basketball animations.

Examples of Winning Outcomes

A successful shot could be presented as:

Swish

The basketball goes directly through the net without touching the rim.

Rim + In

The basketball hits the rim and falls into the basket.

Backboard + In

The basketball hits the backboard and enters.

Multiple Rim Bounces + In

The basketball hits the rim several times before eventually dropping through the basket.

High Arc Shot

A beautiful high-trajectory shot enters the basket.

Contested Three-Pointer

The defender almost blocks the shot, but the shooter releases it just in time and scores.

Dramatic Buzzer-Style Shot

The shot travels through the air with a cinematic camera before entering the basket.

The goal is to make successful outcomes visually different from each other.

Examples of Losing Outcomes

A losing result could be presented in multiple ways.

Rim + Out

The ball hits the rim and bounces away.

Back Rim Miss

The ball appears close to scoring but hits the back of the rim.

In-and-Out

The basketball partially enters the basket before spinning back out.

Backboard + Miss

The basketball hits the backboard but does not enter.

Air Ball

The basketball completely misses the basket.

This should happen less frequently because it is less dramatic than a close miss.

Defender Block — Three-Point Mode Only

The defender blocks the basketball before or immediately after release.

Defender Deflection — Three-Point Mode Only

The defender touches the basketball and causes the shot to miss.

The important concept is:

A losing result should still be visually entertaining.

Suspense & Rim Physics

The rim should play a very important role in creating suspense.

We want moments where the player cannot immediately tell whether the shot will go in.

For example:

Shot → Ball hits front rim → Ball bounces upward → Slow motion → Ball hits rim again → Ball falls in.

Or:

Shot → Ball hits rim → Appears to fall inside → Spins around the basket → Comes back out.

These moments are extremely valuable because they create tension around the result.

The player should sometimes think:

“Is it going in?”

before the result becomes obvious.

Slow-Motion System

Certain shots should automatically trigger a **slow-motion sequence**.

Slow motion should NOT happen on every shot.

It should be reserved for selected dramatic moments.

Examples:

Rim Suspense

Ball hits the rim → slow motion → second bounce → basket.

In-and-Out

Ball enters part of the rim → slow motion → spins around → comes out.

Block Attempt

Defender jumps → slow motion → defender's hand comes extremely close to the ball → shooter releases.

Dramatic Block

Shooter jumps → defender jumps → slow motion → defender blocks the shot.

High-Value Three-Pointer

A particularly important Three-Point round could use a more cinematic ball-following camera.

The purpose of slow motion is to increase suspense, not simply make the animation longer.

Free Throw Experience

Free Throw should feel simple, clean and focused.

The scene includes:

- Shooter
- Basketball
- Hoop
- Court
- Crowd in the background
- Shot timing
- Ball and rim physics

No defender.

The player takes the shot directly from the free-throw line.

Because there is no defender, most of the excitement should come from:

Timing → Ball Flight → Rim → Result

Free Throw should therefore be faster and simpler than Three-Point Mode.

Three-Point Experience

Three-Point Mode should feel more intense.

The scene includes:

- Shooter
- Basketball
- Defender
- Hoop
- Court
- Crowd
- Different three-point shooting positions
- Different camera angles

Not every three-point shot should come from exactly the same location.

Possible positions:

- Left wing
- Right wing
- Top of the three-point line
- Left corner
- Right corner

This creates variety while keeping the core mechanic simple.

The defender's position and movement can also change depending on the scenario.

Three-Point Mode should have **higher potential multipliers / payouts** than Free Throw because it represents the more difficult and dramatic game mode.

Camera System

Camera variation should help make rounds feel less repetitive.

Possible camera angles:

Standard Third-Person

Primary gameplay camera behind/near the shooter.

Side Camera

Shows the shooter's release and defender.

Ball-Follow Camera

Camera follows the basketball toward the basket.

Basket Camera

Camera positioned near or behind the hoop.

Slow-Motion Close-Up

Used for dramatic rim interactions and blocks.

Replay Camera

Optional short cinematic replay after particularly impressive shots.

For the MVP, we do not need many cameras.

A small number of high-quality camera angles is better than many low-quality ones.

Character Reactions

The character should react after the result.

For a successful basket:

- Celebration
- Fist pump
- Confident walk
- Quick hand gesture
- Crowd reaction

For a miss:

- Frustrated reaction
- Looking at the rim
- Small head movement
- Immediate preparation for another attempt

These animations should be short.

We do not want celebrations to slow down the game loop.

Post-Shot Flow

Immediately after every shot, the player should have an easy option to continue.

For example:

SHOOT AGAIN

or

CHANGE GAME MODE

The goal is to minimize friction between rounds.

The player should be able to quickly take another Free Throw or Three-Point Shot without unnecessary menus or loading screens.

The experience should flow naturally:

Shot → Result → Reaction → Shoot Again

Betting Mathematics

The final regulated game requires a defined mathematical model covering:

- RTP (Return to Player)
- House Edge
- Free Throw scoring probability
- Three-Point scoring probability
- Free Throw payout
- Three-Point payout
- Block outcome distribution
- Miss outcome distribution
- Double-or-Nothing probabilities if implemented
- Maximum multiplier
- Maximum possible payout
- Volatility
- Frequency of different animation outcomes

The underlying betting result and the basketball presentation should be separated technically.

Conceptually:

Bet → Game Math / RNG → Result → Select Compatible Basketball Animation → Present Result

For example:

Winning Three-Pointer

could visually become:

Clean Swish

or

Rim + In

or

Contested Shot + Basket

While:

Losing Three-Pointer

could become:

Rim + Out

or

In-and-Out

or

Defender Block

or

Defender Deflection + Miss

This animation variety is extremely important for preventing the game from feeling repetitive.

MVP Objective

This is a very early MVP.

We do not need a full basketball game.

We do not need:

- Full basketball matches
- Teams
- Complex basketball AI
- Passing
- Dribbling systems
- Multiple arenas
- Large character collections

The MVP should focus almost entirely on making the shooting loop entertaining.

The MVP should primarily prove four things:

1. Is taking the basketball shot genuinely fun?
 2. Does the user feel involved between placing the bet and receiving the result?
 3. Does the defender make Three-Point Mode more exciting and different from Free Throw Mode?
 4. Does the user immediately want to take another shot?
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Core MVP Focus

The core focus should therefore be:

Basketball + Interaction + Character Selection + High-Quality Shooting Animations + Defender Mechanics + Suspense + Replayability

The most important development principle is:

DO NOT BUILD ROULETTE WITH A BASKETBALL SKIN.

The valuable part of the product is everything that happens between starting the round and receiving the result.

For Free Throw:

Bet → Player → Timing → Shot → Ball Flight → Rim Suspense → Result

For Three-Point:

Bet → Player → Defender Approaches → Timing → Shot / Block Attempt → Ball Flight → Rim Suspense → Result

That middle section is what should make the product feel like a game.

The player should finish a round thinking:

“I want to take another shot.”

Not simply:

“I want to place another bet.”

Sound Design & Basketball Atmosphere

Sound design is a **high-priority part of the game experience**.

The game should sound and feel like a real basketball environment. Almost every meaningful action on the court should have corresponding audio feedback.

The sound system should include:

- Basketball bouncing on the court
- Player footsteps and shoe squeaks
- Player movement sounds
- Ball leaving the player's hands
- Clean **swish / net sound**
- Ball hitting the front, side, or back of the rim
- Ball hitting the backboard
- Multiple rim bounces
- Defender blocking the ball
- Defender touching or deflecting the ball
- Ball hitting the floor after a miss
- Player reactions
- Crowd ambience
- Crowd reactions to successful shots
- Crowd reactions to dramatic misses
- Stronger crowd reactions for difficult or dramatic Three-Point shots

The **basket and rim sounds are especially important**.

A clean swish should sound completely different from a shot that hits the rim three times before going in.

For example:

Clean Three-Pointer → SWISH → Immediate crowd reaction

Dramatic Shot → Rim → Rim → Slow Motion → Ball Drops In → Net Sound → Large crowd reaction

Miss → Rim → Ball Bounces Out → Crowd reaction

Blocked Three-Pointer → Defender contact → Ball deflection → Player/Crowd reaction

The crowd should also react dynamically rather than playing the same background audio continuously.

During the preparation for an important shot, the atmosphere can become slightly quieter or more tense. When the result happens, the crowd reaction should immediately reinforce what happened.

Sound should work together with the animations, camera system and slow motion to increase suspense.

The goal is for the player to be able to **feel the result through the sound**, not only see it visually.

For the MVP, we do not need an extremely complex audio system, but the core basketball sounds must feel high-quality, responsive and synchronized perfectly with the animations.

Sound should not be treated as background decoration. It is a core part of making every shot feel satisfying and making the game feel like basketball rather than a simple casino animation.